

ELİF USKUPLU

July 18, 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Homotopy type theory and its extensions
- Formalized mathematics and proof assistants
- Categorical semantics of type theories
- Natural logic
- Ethical use of AI in mathematics and education
- Combinatorial design theory and its application in coding theory

EDUCATION

- 2023 University of Southern California**
Ph.D. in Mathematics, 3.70/4.00
Advisor: Aaron Lauda, University of Southern California
Advisor: Michael Shulman, University of San Diego
- 2019 Koç University**
M.S. in Mathematics, 3.99/4.00
- 2017 Istanbul Bilgi University**
B.Sc. in Mathematics, 3.65/4.00
- 2013 Istanbul Technical University**
Mathematical Engineering, *Left due to undergraduate transfer*

EMPLOYMENT & EXPERIENCE

- August 2024 –** Indiana University, Bloomington, IN.
Zorn Postdoctoral Fellow
- January 2024 – May 2024** University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA.
Lecturer
- September 2019 – December 2023** University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA.
Teaching Assistant
- September 2017 – August 2019** Koc University, Istanbul, Turkey.
Teaching Assistant
- September 2018 – August 2019** Istanbul Bilgi University, Istanbul, Turkey.
Teaching Assistant

6. **Formalizing the Bruck–Ryser–Chowla Theorem: Combinatorial Design Theory in Lean**, Eric Jonathan Wang, Elif Uskuplu, *17th International Conference on Interactive Theorem Proving (ITP 2026)*, Leibniz International Proceedings in Informatics (LIPIcs), vol. 382, (2026).
[doi:10.4230/LIPIcs.ITP.2026.19](https://doi.org/10.4230/LIPIcs.ITP.2026.19)
5. **FormalProofBench: Can Models Write Graduate Level Math Proofs That Are Formally Verified?**, Nikil Ravi, Kexing Ying, Vasilii Nesterov, Rayan Krishnan, Elif Uskuplu, Bingyu Xia, Janitha Aswedige, Langston Nashold, *ICLR 2026 Workshop VerifAI-2*, (2026).
[OpenReview](#)
4. **KnowTeX: Visualizing Mathematical Dependencies**, Elif Uskuplu, Lawrence S. Moss, Valeria de Paiva, *arXiv preprint*, (2025).
[arXiv:2601.15294](https://arxiv.org/abs/2601.15294)
3. **Formalizing two-level type theory with cofibrant exo-nat**, Elif Uskuplu, *Mathematical Structures in Computer Science*, vol. 35, p e30 (2025).
[doi:10.1017/S0960129525100297](https://doi.org/10.1017/S0960129525100297).
2. **QC-LDPC codes from difference matrices and difference covering arrays**, Diane Donovan, Asha Rao, Elif Uskuplu, Emine Ş. Yazıcı, *IEEE Access*, vol. 11, pp. 52141–52157, (2023).
[DOI:10.1109/ACCESS.2023.3279327](https://doi.org/10.1109/ACCESS.2023.3279327)
1. **High-rate LDPC codes from partially balanced incomplete block designs**, Diane Donovan, Aiden Price, Asha Rao, Elif Uskuplu, Emine Ş. Yazıcı, *Journal of Algebraic Combinatorics*, Volume 55, 259–275 (2022).
[DOI:10.1007/s10801-021-01111-0](https://doi.org/10.1007/s10801-021-01111-0)

CONFERENCE ABSTRACT PAPERS

5. **Enhancing Dependency Graphs for Research and Alignment in Math**, Valeria de Paiva, Larry Moss, Elif Uskuplu, *Math Datasets and Libraries: alignments and comparisons (ALIGN2025)*, (2025).
4. **From parametricity to identity types**, Thorsten Altenkirch, Ambrus Kaposi, Michael Shulman, Elif Uskuplu, *31th International Conference on Types for Proofs and Programs TYPES 2025*, (2025).
3. **Internal relational parametricity, without an interval**, Thorsten Altenkirch, Ambrus Kaposi, Michael Shulman, Elif Uskuplu, *30th International Conference on Types for Proofs and Programs TYPES 2024*, (2024).
2. **Cofibrancy of The Exo-type of Natural Numbers**, Elif Uskuplu, *The Second International Conference on Homotopy Type Theory*, (2023).
[Abstract paper](#)
1. **An Experiment with 2LTT Features in Agda**, Elif Uskuplu, *Workshop on Homotopy Type Theory/ Univalent Foundations*, (2022).
[Abstract paper](#)

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

Oct 10 2025	Enhancing Dependency Graphs for Research and Alignment in Math, <i>The Workshop on Math Datasets: Alignments and Comparisons (Align 2025)</i> .
May 17 2025	Monotonicity and Natural Logic: Tracking Meaning with Arrows, <i>The AWM Research Symposium, Logic Across Mathematics Session</i> .
January 25 2025	Formalizing locally nameless syntax with cofinite quantification, <i>WITS 25</i> .
September 25 & October 2 2024	From Propositions to Proof Assistants: A Journey through Type Theory, <i>IUB Logic Seminars</i> .
Feb 2024	Navigating the New Frontier: Formalized Mathematics,

May 2023	WiMSoCal 2024. Cofibrancy of The Exo-type of Natural Numbers, <i>2nd International Conference on Homotopy Type Theory.</i>
December 2022	Homotopy Type Theory vs Set Theory, <i>GSU Research Seminars.</i>
August 2022	Proof Assistants: Agda for Beginners, <i>SageDays Istanbul.</i>
July 2022	An Experiment with 2LTT Features in Agda, <i>Workshop on Homotopy Type Theory/Univalent Foundation.</i>
July 2022	Formalization of 2LTT in Agda, <i>MURI Meeting at CMU.</i>
February 2022	A Brief Introduction to Homotopy Type Theory, <i>USC Math Grad Colloquium.</i>

SOFTWARE & FORMALIZATION PROJECTS

8. **KnowTeX: Visualizing Mathematical Dependencies**, [github repository](#).
7. **Two-Level Type Theory**, Elif Uskuplu with Agda contributors, *Documentation for the two-level flag in Agda Library*.
[Link](#)
6. **Narya: A proof assistant for higher-dimensional type theory (as a contributor)**, [github repository](#).
5. **PrimeNumberTheoremAnd: Formalization of the Prime Number Theorem in Lean4 (as a contributor)**, [github repository](#).
4. **Combinatorial Designs Formalization in Lean4**, with Eric Jonathan Wang.
3. **Formalization of 2LTT & Univalence Principle in Agda**, [github repository](#).
2. **Univalent mathematics in Agda (as a contributor)**, [github repository](#).
1. **Simply Typed Lambda Calculus with de Bruijn Indices in Lean4**, [github repository](#).

HONORS, AWARDS & FUNDING

10. Max Zorn Teaching Award, Awarded by the Department of Mathematics at Indiana University in recognition of excellence in the teaching of mathematics, 2026.
9. Travel & Participation Grant, Simons Foundation - 2025 MPS Workshop on Lean, Awarded full funding to attend a selective workshop on Lean formalization methods.
8. The Edward and Dolores Blum Research Prize, Awarded to select doctorate students in recognition to their outstanding research in the Department of Mathematics at USC, 2023
7. Research Support by the grant of Michael Shulman, the Air Force Office of Scientific Research under award number FA9550-21-1-0009
6. Research support by the grant of Aaron Lauda, the NSF grant DMS-1902092, the Army Research Office W911NF-20-1-0075, and Simons Foundation
5. Outstanding Teaching Award, Koç University
4. The Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TUBITAK), ARDEB 1001 Research Project Scholarship, Grant Number: 116F166, Grant Provider: E. Şule Yazici

3. İstanbul Bilgi University the Board of Trustee Scholarship
2. Turkish Math Society, Cahit Arf Scholarship
1. Higher Education Student Student Loans and Dormitories Institution State Scholarship, Turkey

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

3. Program Committee Member, *LSFA 2026: Logical and Semantic Frameworks with Applications*, [link](#).
2. Peer Reviewer, Cambridge University Press – *Forum of Mathematics, Sigma*, 2025
1. Peer Reviewer, *The 31st International Conference on Computational Linguistics, COLING 2025*

COMMUNITY & OUTREACH

3. **USC Women in Mathematics Group**, research event coordinator, [link](#).
2. **Directed Reading Program Türkiye**, mentorship, [link](#).
1. **Mathematics Solidarity Platform**, volunteer, [link](#).

PARTICIPATIONS

12. **Mathematics and Physical Sciences Workshop on Lean**, *Simons Foundation, New York City*, June, 2025.
11. **Formalization of Mathematics**, *The Simons Laufer Mathematical Sciences Institute (formerly MSRI)*, June, 2023.
10. **HoTT '23 and MURI '23 (joint event)**, *Carnegie Mellon University*, May, 2023.
9. **HoTTEST Summer School 2022**, *online participation*, July - August, 2022.
8. **MURI Meeting '22**, *Carnegie Mellon University*, June, 2022.
7. **Logic and Higher Structures**, *Centre International De Rencontres Mathematiques*, February, 2022.
6. **Istanbul Design Theory Workshop**, *Koc University*, September, 2018.
5. **Workshop on Graph Theory and its Applications**, *Gebze Technical University*, November, 2017.
4. **Undergraduate and Graduate Summer School**, *Nesin Mathematical Village,,* June, 2017.
3. **TMD Analysis Summer School**, *Feza Gursey Institute*, July, 2016.
2. **Logic Summer School**, *Feza Gursey Institute*, August, 2015.
1. **Philosophy and Mathematics Symposium**, *Yeditepe University*, February, 2014.